BACHELOR OF COMPUTER APPLICATIONS

SEMESTER 1

TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

Unit 6

Job Application Essentials & Interview Skills

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1. INTRODUCTION

In the previous unit 5, learners studied the fundamental aspects of professional communication, gaining knowledge in the organisation and manner of expression in different media such as emails, memoranda, reports, and proposals. Their study focused on the significance of customising the tone according to the audience, following established guidelines for clarity and efficiency, and utilising impactful formatting and persuasive strategies. Learners thoroughly understood how to create impactful messages customised to meet specific organisational requirements by understanding the purpose and format of memos, the types and structures of reports, and the strategies for writing persuasive business proposals.

This unit focuses on the sophisticated details of Job Application Essentials and improving Interview Skills. It aims to help learners understand the importance of each component in the process of finding employment. The course will start with an analysis of the form of the Cover Letter. Participants will learn how to create an interesting introduction, a convincing body that connects their own accomplishments with the job prerequisites, and a captivating conclusion. The need to customise this letter to various employment positions will also be emphasised, highlighting the necessity of demonstrating how one's distinct abilities and experiences qualify one as the ideal candidate. Regarding the Resume, this unit will address various formats, assisting learners in selecting the format most effectively showcasing their skills. This course will explore the techniques of emphasising accomplishments, instructing on how to measure contributions meaningfully, and examining the process of crafting resumes compatible with Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) to increase the likelihood of passing digital screenings. The LinkedIn Profile part will include strategies for maximising visibility and networking, allowing learners to improve their online presence and interact with professionals in their sector as they transition to the digital forefront. Finally, this unit will concentrate on Interview Skills, presenting the STAR Technique to organise responses to behavioural questions effectively. This course will equip learners with the necessary skills to effectively respond to behavioural questions, demonstrating their suitability for the profession. It will also cover the finer points of post-interview etiquette, such as the importance of follow-up communications to express gratitude and sustain interest in the

position. This holistic method provides learners the tools and insights to navigate the job market effectively, from creating the initial application to securing a job offer.

To study this unit, learners should actively participate in practical, experiential learning by generating their written materials and improving their interview skills to study this unit effectively. Individuals can greatly improve their comprehension and readiness by using actual job descriptions, utilising web resources, and participating in mock interviews. Obtaining input from colleagues or mentors and staying updated on current trends are essential for ongoing enhancement. Adapting applications to suit unique positions and continually analysing personal experiences will also help create real and convincing job applications and interviews, ultimately enhancing success in the industry.

1.1 Learning Objectives

At the end of this unit, learners should be able to:

- *Recall different resume formats.*
- *Explain effective strategies for networking on LinkedIn.*
- *Construct a cover letter adhering to the industry-standard structure.*
- *Apply the STAR technique to structure responses to Behavioral interview questions.*

2. COVER LETTER

A cover message, also known as a cover letter or letter of application, is a graceful way of introducing your résumé. Job candidates often labour over their résumés but treat the cover message as an afterthought. Some candidates even question whether a cover message is necessary in today's digital world.

Cover letters allow you—in narrative form—to tell the employer exactly why hiring you, instead of the numerous other candidates, is a good decision. Cover messages reveal to employers your ability to compose complete sentences and sound intelligent.

Although recruiting professionals favour cover messages, they disagree about their length. Some prefer short messages with no more than two paragraphs embedded in an e-mail message.34 Other recruiters desire longer messages that supply more information, thus giving them a better opportunity to evaluate a candidate's qualifications and writing skills. These recruiters argue that hiring and training new employees is expensive and time-consuming; therefore, they welcome extra data to guide them in making the best choice the first time. Follow your judgment in writing a brief or a longer cover message. If you feel, for example, that you need space to explain in more detail what you can do for a prospective employer, do so.

Regardless of its length, a cover message should have three primary parts:

(a) an opening that captures attention, introduces the message and identifies the position

(b) a body that sells the candidate and focuses on the employer's needs and

(c) a closing that requests an interview and motivates action. When putting your cover message together, remember that the biggest mistake job seekers make when writing cover messages is being too generic.

Hence, one should, write a personalised, customised cover message for every position that interests you.

What makes a Good Cover Letter?

A good cover letter:

- Highlights how your skills and attributes tie to the needs of the department and the specific role

- Demonstrates effective communication skills
- Creates a lasting impression
- Explains the "why" (why this department, why this role)
- Tells a story and brings your resume to life (they complement each other)

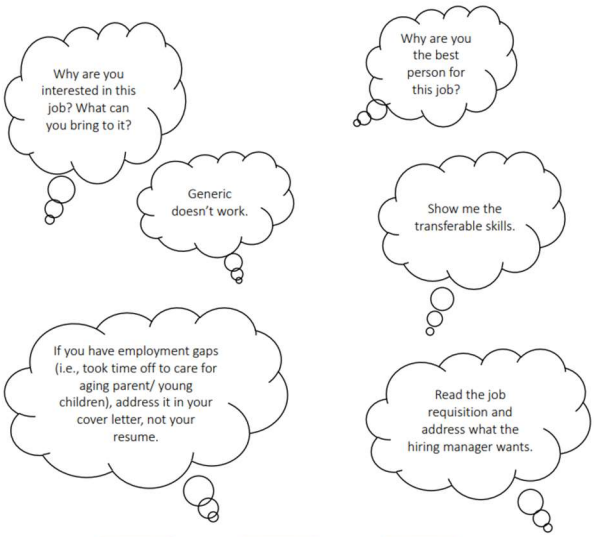

Fig 1: Maximizing your cover letter

Guidelines:

The following checklist is a guide for writing and editing your cover letter:

GENERAL	Y/N?
Make a clear statement of what value you will bring to the department and role.	
Make it easy for the reader. Identify what key skills, experiences, and attributes you offer.	
Convey your passion for the University, department, and role.	
Tailor the content throughout, not just in the introduction.	
Provide information beyond what is found in your resume.	
RESEARCH	
Use specific information garnered from online research, informational interviews, and other sources to demonstrate your interest and fit with the department and role.	
Mention individuals you've had *meaningful* conversations with when appropriate (i.e., informational interviews vs saying that you know someone who knows someone).	
MATCH TO JOB DESCRIPTION	
Draw connections between the job requirements and your skills, experiences, and attributes.	
Use specific examples. Quantify or qualify results in alignment with their competencies.	
Address the key requirements listed in the job description.	
Translate prior experiences to demonstrate preparedness for the desired role.	
FORMAT	
Do not exceed one page (½ to ¾ of a page is enough).	
Use an 11 or 12 pt font.	
Ensure margins are at least 1" all around.	
Use proper business formatting and spacing.	
Include your contact information and the hiring manager's contact information. if not known use "Dear Hiring Manager" instead.	
Incorporate a good amount of white space.	
WHAT TO AVOID:	
Do not use the same generic cover letter for multiple jobs (customize one for each role).	
Do not have the same skills/experiences in each letter (tailor to the specific job requirements).	
Do not write from the "me" perspective (this focuses on what the opportunity will do for you and doesn't tell the reader what value you bring to their organization).	
Do not restate what is written in your resume. Do not copy and paste your job description into the cover letter either. Your cover letter should not be a list of your past experiences and jobs.	
Do not include spelling errors, jargon, grammatical errors, or other mistakes.	
Do not lack the relevance or level of interest to make the reader want to learn more.	

Fig 2: Checklist as a guide

Cover Letter Formatting:

Cover Letters should not be more than one page long, as shown in Figure 3. You can look at the pattern the words create, the use of whitespace, the centering or left justifying of the text, and the appropriate use of bullets.

[Your Name]
[Street Address]
[City, ST ZIP Code]
[phone number]
[email]

[Date]

[Recipient Name]
[Title]
[Company Name]
[Street Address]
[City, ST ZIP Code]

Dear [Recipient Name]:

xxxx

2.1 Structure

The basic structure of a cover letter:

First Paragraph – the Introduction - WHY you are writing

GET THEM TO KEEP READING

- Clearly state who you are and why you are writing.
- Give any compelling reasons why you are applying to the position. e.g., "I was excited to see

XYZ posting on STARS as it speaks to my background in X and my passion in Y."

- Incorporate your research, including employees you have spoken to via networking and informational interviewing.
- Remember: this is the appetizer (teaser). At a restaurant, if the appetizer is fantastic the odds that you will have a great meal are pretty good, so people stay and keep eating! In a cover letter, you want to think about your hook and get them to keep reading so that they want to know more.

Second Paragraph – the Body – WHAT you have to offer

GET THEM TO CONNECT THE DOTS

• Make your case, draw connections between the job requirements and your own skills, experiences, and attributes.

• Highlight 1 or 2 specific accomplishments but do NOT repeat your resume.

• If you are making a career switch, state your case.

• Show what you have to offer. Describe the skills and experiences that make you a match for the job and the attributes and qualities make you a good fit with their culture. GIVE EXAMPLES of these.

- Remember, this is the meat and potatoes, the heaviest/largest part of the meal. The most memorable part, where you will convince the reader you are worth interviewing.

Third and Last Paragraph – the Closing – WHAT you want and HOW you will follow-up

GET THEM TO TAKE ACTION

- Restate your interest and enthusiasm.
- Recap what YOU can do for THEM and how the department will benefit from hiring you.
- Make a specific ask (usually an interview) and outline your follow-up.
- Thank the reader for their time and consideration
- Remember: this is the dessert. End the meal on a great note to land an interview. Make a lasting impression

2.2 Customizing for Job Roles

Each cover letter should be customized. Tailor it to the department AND the specific requirements of the position. Remember: Departments and roles are NOT interchangeable. The cover letter addresses each position individually.

There are two primary tools you can leverage to tailor your cover letter; conducting research and reading the job description. Let's take a look at conducting research first:

Conducting Research – this should be done in order to:

- Learn information beyond the basic work (e.g., values and culture of the department, leadership styles, etc.).
- Identify the roles and career tracks of interest.
- Demonstrate that you have had meaningful conversations (informational interviews).

Here are a few ways to find some of the information above:

- Search the department website or Workday to identify the name of the department lead. Review the makeup of the team (how many employees, their job titles, etc.). Find someone to conduct an informational interview with. Learn more about the backgrounds and career paths of each of the team members.
- Google the department and or department lead and see what you can learn. For example, google "Yale Cell Biology" and click on "department news" you will see that James Rothman won the Nobel Prize for Medicine in 2013, this is great information for a cover letter and an interview!

- Look on LinkedIn - the previous person may have noted what he or she did in that role and you may gain an idea of their career progression or background.

Customization - Job Descriptions

Job Descriptions can be a great source of information. Look for key words and phrases that match what the Recruiter or Hiring Manager is looking for. Determine where the overlap or gaps are in your experience and skills. This is a great way to keep your eyes on the prize.

Fig 4: Attributes of the cover letter

Example: The employee is currently an Administrative Assistant for one of the museums at XYZ. He is applying to a Senior Administrative Assistant role which is coordinating the work of other Administrative Assistants that support a group of faculty members. The circle on the left shows the requirements of the job while the circle on the right shows his skills and attributes. The intersection of these two circles should be the focus of his cover letter as shown in the above figure 4.

Sample Cover Letter - Before

Jane Smith
123 Main Street
New Haven, CT 06500

June 26, 2015

Human Resources
Yale University
221 Whitney Avenue
New Haven, CT 06511

To whom it may concern,

I am writing to apply for the Leadership Giving Officer position at Yale University (STARS requisition #31959BR). I have been at Yale working as an Advancement Officer for two years, so that should position me well. This fits my career goals perfectly, as I want to stay at the University.

Here is what I do each day, and what I have achieved thus far:

- Managed a portfolio of 100-200 Annual Fund and Major Gift prospects through successful qualification, cultivation, solicitation, and stewardship stages.
- Secured over $300,000 in commitments with over $225,000 being paid in the current year.
- Exceeded fundraising goals, including number of prospect visits, number of leadership gift solicitations, cash and commitments secured, and percentage of increased gifts.
- Managed the largest Annual Fund program, consisting of 60 volunteer solicitors, which generated over $1.1M of unrestricted revenue— the largest amount ever generated by this program.

As an Advancement Officer at the same institution, I have had the opportunity to prove myself as a skilled fundraiser. In my first year at Yale, I surpassed all of my individual fundraising goals and I got a 4 on my performance review. I have also had the opportunity to build relationships with campus leaders and fundraising prospects, which will enable me to quickly adapt to a new position in the same space.

I started my career in the Army, where I obtained and refined the skills that have made me successful in the field of development. I served as a Civil Affairs Sergeant both stateside and in Afghanistan. My job involved building relationships with local civilians, domestic and foreign governments, and non-governmental organizations. I was responsible for leveraging those relationships to obtain resources such as money, expertise, and cooperation. I have found that my responsibilities in the military are directly applicable to my responsibilities as a fundraiser. I have been able to use this training in my current position to build and leverage relationships with prospects to help achieve the highest priorities of the Institute.

Outside of work and school, I strive to give back to my community by volunteering with local nonprofit organizations. I have served in leadership capacities with several different organizations. This has given me the opportunity to build fundraising and marketing initiatives with very limited resources, which has helped me in my career.

I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to be interviewed for this position and to discuss how my education and experience fits the needs of Yale University. Please feel free to contact me at (203) 432-5555 or jane.smith@yale.edu. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Jane Smith

Commented [LD1]: GOOD: format looks nice, clean, easy to read
NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: this should not be two pages

Commented [LD2]: NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: Better to have a specific name and title or use "Recruiter" or "Hiring Manager".

Commented [LD3]: NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: Better to have a specific name or say "Dear Recruiter" or "Dear Hiring Manager".

Commented [LD4]: GOOD: hook showing that she is already working in the field.

Commented [LD5]: NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: she shouldn't say "that should position me well". She should show how she is well positioned and prove it.

Commented [LD6]: GOOD: like seeing the bullet points of the top accomplishments (just be careful not to repeat what is on the resume).
NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: shouldn't say "here is what I do each day".

Commented [LD7]: GOOD: "I surpassed my individual fundraising goals"
NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: by what %?
NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: not appropriate to talk about annual review rating.
GOOD: "Opportunity to build relationships" – which is a key skill in the job description.

Commented [LD8]: GOOD: tying military to career
NEEDS IMPROVEMENT: this paragraph is a bit repetitive, she says twice that her responsibilities in the army related to her responsibilities in fundraising (first sentence and fourth sentence).

Commented [LD9]: GOOD: showing how extracurricular is related to career

Commented [LD10]: GOOD: nice close

Sample Cover Letter – After

Jane Smith
117 Monmouth Way
New Haven, CT 06511
June 26, 20xx

Ms. Anne Jones Recruiter
Yale University
221 Whitney Avenue New Haven, CT 06511
Dear Ms. Jones,

I am writing to apply for the Leadership Giving Officer position at Yale University (STARS requisition #31959BR). As an Advancement Officer at the same institution, I have had the opportunity to prove myself as a skilled fundraiser. In my first year at Yale, I surpassed all of my individual fundraising goals. Some of my most notable accomplishments are: leading a team of 60 volunteers to raise over $1.1M in unrestricted funds, achieving an 82% proposal commitment rate and raising over $325,000 in gifts and multi-year pledges. I have also had the opportunity to build relationships with school leaders and fundraising prospects, which will enable me to quickly adapt to a new position with enhanced responsibility and greater campus collaborations.

I started my career in the Army, where I built relationships with local civilians, domestic and foreign governments, and non-governmental organizations. I was responsible for leveraging those relationships to obtain resources such as money, expertise, and cooperation. I have been able to use this training in my current position to build and leverage relationships with prospects to help achieve the highest priorities of the University. In addition to my professional experience, I am currently pursuing my Ph.D. part-time in Higher Education Administration and Policy with a focus on philanthropy in higher education. My dissertation will examine the impact of public recognition in the decision-making process of major gift donors. Outside of work and school, I strive to give back to my community by volunteering with local nonprofit organisations and helping plan yearly fundraising events. I have served

in leadership capacities with several different organizations. This has given me the opportunity to build fundraising and marketing initiatives with very limited resources.

I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to be interviewed for this position and to discuss how my education and experience fits the needs of Yale University. Please feel free to contact me at (203) 432- 5555 or jane.smith@yale.edu. Thank you for your time and consideration.
Sincerely,
Jane Smith

3. RESUME

An excellent resume can captivate the interest of a recruiter or hiring manager, setting you apart from other candidates. Properly formatting your resume is crucial in crafting a polished and easily reading document.

There are multiple methods to structure your resume. One of the initial choices you must make is your resume format: chronological, functional, or combination. Each CV style is advantageous for individuals with diverse backgrounds and goals. When making precise formatting choices, such as determining the number of margins or selecting a font style, your objective is to create a document that enables employers to recognise why you are well-suited for the job promptly.

There are three popular resume formats:

i. Chronological
ii. functional
iii. combination.

i. Chronological:

Resume organised in chronological order

A chronological resume presents your work history in a sequential sequence, starting with your most recent employment at the top and moving backwards in time. The classic resume format has been the prevailing choice for many years.

A chronological resume format often presents the following information in a specific sequence:

- Contact details
- Objective or summary statement
- Work history
- Key competencies
- Academic background
- Supplementary details (such as voluntary contributions and personal hobbies—optional)

A chronological resume is an optimal option for individuals with a constant and progressive employment path. An instance of this would be using a chronological resume structure if you have been working in the same business for the past several years and each position you have held has been more senior than the previous one. Additionally, it is frequently utilised by individuals who are seeking employment in the same or a related industry based on the bulk of their professional background.

However, suppose you have several gaps in your employment history, are seeking a career change, or have diverse work experience. In that case, it may be advisable to go for a functional or combo resume.

ii. Functional

A functional CV focuses on key abilities over employment history. The chronological approach emphasises work experience by providing extensive descriptions of successes within each position, whereas the functional format focuses on the applicant's skill set.

A functional resume format often presents the following information in a specific sequence:

- Contact details
- Objective or summary statement
- Skills Summary
- Professional background
- Academic qualifications
- Supplementary details (such as volunteer experience and specific hobbies)

A functional CV is most suitable when there are several years of unemployment, transitioning to a new career with limited industry-specific experience, or returning to work after a lengthy break.

Occasionally, a functional resume may have overly restrictive constraints. If you possess a certain level of expertise and have minimal or no periods of unemployment in your work history, opting for a combo resume may be the most suitable decision.

iii. Combination.

A combination resume is a hybrid of the chronological and functional resume formats. This resume style enables you to highlight both your professional experience and key abilities. If your skills and career experience take up most of your resume, you may need to remove optional parts like volunteer work or particular interests.

A combo resume format often presents the following information in a certain sequence:

- Contact details.
- Objective or summary
- statement
- Professional experience
- Key Skills Summary
- Acquiring knowledge and skills through formal instruction and learning.

The combination resume offers greater flexibility by allowing you to choose whether to prioritise your abilities or your work experience, based on which you deem more crucial for the position. If you possess numerous distinct abilities that hold significant value in the industry you are seeking employment in, it might be advisable to prioritise stating them before your work experience. Examining the job description might provide valuable insights into the employer's priorities when it comes to an ideal candidate.

3.1 Formats

Formatting your resume aims to provide a polished, legible document that conveys professionalism. Employers have a limited timeframe to review your resume, so it is important to make formatting choices that ensure information is presented clearly and easily accessible. If you are modifying an existing resume, you may need to modify some words or

phrases to ensure it remains easily readable after applying formatting modifications. Before composing your resume, it is essential to thoroughly consider the visual presentation of the content on the page and make necessary adjustments accordingly.

Here are the key steps for formatting a resume:

a) Apply appropriate margins.
b) Select a professional, readable font.
c) Make your font size 10–12 points.
d) Feature section headers.
e) Use bullet points.
f) Ask for feedback.

a) Apply appropriate margins:

Setting appropriate margins for your paper guarantees that the information is contained inside an area on the page that is easy to read. The standard practice for resumes and other formal papers, such as cover letters or resignation letters, is to maintain a one-inch margin on all sides. If your resume is quite brief and contains much empty space, you can utilise broader margins to produce a less visually visible document that gives the impression of being more substantial. If you choose to modify your margins, it is necessary to ensure that they remain below 1.5 inches.

Additionally, you must ensure your resume is left-aligned to enhance readability. If considered suitable and legible, one may opt to position specific section headings in the centre to enhance the looks of their resume.

b) Select a professional, readable font.

When selecting a font for your resume, focus on clarity and legibility. When selecting a font for your resume, the primary consideration is ensuring employers can comprehend the words without much effort. Additionally, it is advantageous to submit your resume via an application tracking system (ATS). Many businesses utilise an Applicant Tracking System (ATS), which may not consistently understand and interpret complex fonts effectively. You must avoid using "light" or "thin" fonts, as they might be challenging to read on both screens and paper.

Fonts can be classified into two primary categories: ***serif and sans serif.*** The presence of tails characterises serif fonts, whereas sans serif fonts lack them. Sans serif fonts, which lack decorative tails, are typically recommended for resumes due to their clean and legible lines. While fonts like Georgia are typically considered among employers as straightforward and professional, there are a few others that are as highly regarded.

Here are some examples of the best resume fonts:

- Avenir
- Calibri
- Cambria
- Constantia
- Corbel
- Franklin Gothic
- Garamond
- Georgia
- Gill Sans
- Helvetica

c) Make your font size 10–12 points.

Setting an acceptable font size is another thing that contributes to the good readability of your content. You must maintain a font size ranging from 10 to 12 points. To minimise the amount of space, opt for a 12-point font. Anything above the current level of detail may give the impression of being overly exaggerated or lacking in professionalism. To accommodate a substantial amount of content on your page, commence with a font size of 10 points and augment it accordingly if sufficient space is available.

If your resume exceeds one page, even with a 10-point font, refrain from further decreasing the font size. Instead, explore the possibility of condensing your thoughts to make them more concise. To do this, eliminate any irrelevant or superfluous information, consolidate concepts, and condense your thoughts by using shorter sentences and reducing filler words.

Here are a few other techniques you can use to write a shorter resume:

- Consider removing filler words such as 'like,' 'with,' 'a,' 'and' and 'that'.
- Instead of listing each function of every job you have held, pick 2–3 key impacts you made in those roles.
- If you have two similar points, consider combining them into one brief statement.

d) Feature section headers.

Employers can speed up their search for information by utilising techniques such as bolding, underlining, or raising the font size for section headers. Take care while formatting section headings. It is necessary to distinguish them from the main body of the section in a neat and professional manner.

You can customise the appearance of your headers using many methods.

- Apply a 'bold' font to your section headers.
- Enlarge the font size of your section headers to either 12, 14, or 16 points.
- Promote your section headers.

Additionally, you can implement these designs to your name and contact details at the top of your resume. This information must be prominently displayed easily legible and accessible for employers.

e) Use bullet points.

Employers can efficiently extract the most relevant data from your history using bullet points in your experience, talents, or education sections. It is mandatory to utilise bullet points to list your accomplishments. Avoid utilising a small number of bullet points. When you have fewer than three bits of information, you can present them in sentence form without bullets or use additional punctuation to distinguish various concepts.

When describing a position you have held in the experience area, you should utilise bullet points to convey your achievements in that function effectively.

- Operated overhead cranes, hoists, power tools, and other project equipment consistently and safely.
- Addressed the expected requirements of 11 employees present at the worksite and provided necessary components to 23 technicians operating in the field.

- Executed weekly service reports, timecards, and other pertinent project equipment paperwork.

f) Ask for feedback.

Once you have completed the task of writing and designing your CV, seek the assistance of reliable friends or colleagues to evaluate it critically. Obtaining the view and input of an impartial third party can be advantageous. In addition to identifying any language and spelling errors you may have overlooked, they must consider your formatting carefully. Encourage them to assess the text for readability, consistency, and a polished style.

Sample Formats:

Chronological Format:

Viren J Verma

1234 Gandhi Street

Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh 474004

vjverma@email.comObjective

I am a passionate and dedicated communications professional seeking a position with a non-profit organisation where I can apply my public relations skills and my passion for philanthropy.Experience

Public Relations Manager

The Volunteer Foundation, 2017–Present

Plan and direct public relations programmes to create a positive public image for The Volunteer Foundation. Manage PR staff and act as mentor to junior public relations personnel.Public Relations Specialist

The Volunteer Foundation, 2015–2017

Worked alongside the PR team to ensure all fundraising efforts, local events and other special projects met the organisation's brand guidelines and upheld a favourable public image. Communications Coordinator

ABC Company 2013–2015

Helped increase brand visibility through various marketing efforts including social media campaigns and digital advertising efforts. Helped conceptualise and distribute printed marketing materials. Professional Skills• Public relations management

- Corporate communications
- Team leadership
- Interpersonal communications
- Process streamliningEducation

Jawaharlal Nehru University, 2008–2012
Bachelor of Arts in JournalismVolunteer Work
Indian Red Cross Society
Disaster Volunteer, Public Affairs
2016–Present

Functional Format:

Jaya Shah
234 City Street
New Delhi, India 11001
jayas@email.com

Objective

I am a hardworking and driven sales professional with more than ten years of experience. I am seeking an account management position in the healthcare industry.

Areas of Expertise

Medical Device, Supplies and Pharmaceutical Sales

I have a wealth of experience in selling to healthcare organisations ranging from large hospitals to small private practices. In previous roles, I have managed prospecting efforts, relationship development, new client on boarding and account management within both the medical device and pharmaceutical product verticals.

Relationship Management

I am skilled at developing new relationships with prospects and nurturing relationships with existing clients. In previous roles, I used a combination of proficiency in conflict resolution and my ability to build rapport to increase client retention rates as high as 300 percent year over year.

Sales Team Leadership

I have managed sales teams of more than ten sales associates at a time. I have coached and mentored junior sales representatives and regularly led teams to exceed monthly, quarterly and yearly quotas.

Work Experience

Regional Sales Manager

ABC Medical Supplies Pvt. Ltd., 2012–2017

Managed a team of sales associates. Trained and mentored new sales representatives. Oversaw regional account lists averaging more than 90 existing clients and 40 prospects.

Account Manager

XYZ Pharma Co., 2008–2012

Managed a lengthy account list, including private practices and mid-sized clinics. Worked to maximise account growth through regular on-site visits, monthly check-ins and quarterly updates.

Junior Sales Associate

XYZ Pharma Co., 2006–2008

Increased awareness of XYZ Pharma Co. products to small private practices through on-site education. Shared information about new medications to help establish relationships with new prospects.

Education

University of Delhi, 2002–2006

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration

Certifications

Certified by the Indian Pharmaceutical Association

Combination Format:

Aarti Singh

555 Main Avenue

Chennai, Tamil Nadu 65034

arsingh@email.com

Professional Experience

Creative Director

ABC Company, 2015–Present

Managed a team of twelve creatives including designers and copywriters. Oversee all in-house creative projects and ensure all deliverables meet brand guidelines.

Senior Graphic Designer

ABC Company, 2013–2015

Designed creatives for all digital properties. Spearheaded website redesign. Developed in-house brand style guide currently used by the entire creative department.

Graphic Designer

XYZ Creative Agency, 2010–2013

Developed visual concepts for web and print design including websites, mobile sites, digital advertisements, business cards and trade show collateral.

Related Skills

Team Management

Coordinate team of creative resources, lead team meetings and offered mentoring as needed.

Project Management

Managed all aspects of creative projects including timeline, resource coordination, internal communication and sharing progress reports with outside stakeholders.

Branding

Created logos, design brand marks, offered brand colour recommendations and created style guides to ensure cohesiveness across all assets.

Additional Skills

Illustration, Typography, Client Communication, Time Management, Mobile Design, Adobe Creative Suite.

Education

Madras University 2005–2009

Bachelor of Art in Advertising, Certificate in Graphic Design

3.2 Highlighting Achievements

Highlighting achievements in your resume effectively separates you from other applicants by displaying your contributions and successes in past positions.

Below are essential methods for properly emphasising your accomplishments:

i. **Quantify Your Accomplishments:** Use numerical values, percentages, and measurable measures to represent your achievements visually. An instance of this would be the statement, "Achieved a 30% growth in sales during the initial quarter," which presents unambiguous proof of your impact.

ii. **Use Action Verbs:** Start bullet points with active action verbs such as "Implemented," "Developed," or "Achieved" to enhance the prominence of your accomplishments and show a robust feeling of initiative and competence.

iii. **Focus on Results:** Direct your attention towards achieving certain results by highlighting the consequences of your activities. Instead of simply listing tasks or obligations, emphasise the outcomes of your efforts and their advantageous impact on the organisation.

   An example of an achievement is creating and implementing a customer feedback mechanism, resulting in a significant 40% enhancement in customer service ratings.

iv. **Include Awards and recognition: If you have been honoured with any awards or recognition for your professional achievements,** include them in your resume.

This can encompass many types of recognition, from being named employee of the month to receiving prestigious distinctions within the sector.

v. **Personalise Your Accomplishments:** Adapt your resume to each job application by incorporating achievements highly relevant to the position you seek. This demonstrates to companies that you possess specific talents and experiences that align with their requirements.

vi. **Highlight Leadership and Initiative:** Even if you weren't in a management position, showcasing moments when you took the lead on projects or initiatives can demonstrate leadership qualities and a proactive attitude.

vii. **Be Specific:** Provide enough detail to give employers a clear picture of what you did and why it mattered but be concise to keep their attention.

3.3 ATS-friendly Resumes

ATS is an acronym that stands for application tracking system. It is a software application that simplifies a portion of the hiring process for organisations. Instead of relying on individuals to manually review batches of resumes to identify suitable candidates for a job opening, an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) does this tedious task by efficiently sorting and scanning numerous resumes in a significantly shorter period of time.

i.e., an applicant tracking system (ATS) is a software application organisations use to manage and simplify the recruitment and selection process. When you apply online, an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) examines your résumé and retrieves information such as skills, job titles, and educational background. To enhance the likelihood of successfully passing an ATS scan, you must acquire knowledge about the functioning of ATS systems, enabling you to ensure that your resume adheres to ATS requirements.

How does it work?

What is the mechanism behind the functioning of ATS?

When analysing a résumé, an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) searches for fundamental details such as contact information, employment positions, and educational background. It also searches for terms that are actually mentioned in the job advertisement. Resumes that meet the basic requirements for a position are considered above a specific threshold and

forwarded to recruiters and hiring managers for further evaluation. Resumes that do not meet the threshold are not considered for further review.

ATS Resume Template:

To create a template for a resume that follows to ATS standards, adhere to the following structure and formatting guidelines:

Name and contact information

Begin your resume by placing your name on the first line, followed by your city, phone number, and email address on the second line.

Summary

Provide a brief overview of your key abilities and qualifications relevant to the job vacancy. This location is an excellent opportunity to integrate relevant keywords.

Experience (or education)

If you possess job experience that is directly related to your future career objectives, it is advisable to include a distinct section labelled as "Experience" following your summary. Please provide a comprehensive list of all relevant employment positions held during the last 10-15 years, including the job title, employer name, work location, and dates of employment for each entry. Additionally, it is advisable to have multiple bullet points that employ relevant keywords to outline your primary contributions and accomplishments in each position clearly.

If you have recently completed your schooling or lack relevant job experience about your career objectives, it may be advisable to place your education section immediately after your summary. Provide the specific degree type, field of study, name of the institution, and graduation date (if it occurred within the last five years). If this experience was recent, you may incorporate bullet points to outline relevant classes or projects in your education section.

Education (or experience)

Depending on which section you listed first—education or experience—list the other section directly below.

Skills

The last segment you must incorporate into your ATS resume is the skills section. Incorporate short phrases consisting of one, two, or three words corresponding to the keywords mentioned in the resume description.

YOUR NAME

Phone | Email | Location (City, State, ZIP)

Online Portfolio/Professional Website (Optional)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

2-3 sentences or 2-3 bullet points that include your years of professional experience, accomplishments, top skills and strengths related to the position and what you're looking for in your next role.

EXPERIENCE

Title, Company Name ***Start Date - End Date***

- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results

Title, Company Name **Start Date - End Date**

- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results

Title, Company Name **Start Date - End Date**

- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results
- (Action verb) + what you did (more detail) + reason, outcome, or quantified results

EDUCATION

Degree Type, Major (if applicable) ***Month/Year of Completion***

Institution Name

SKILLS

Skill, Skill, Skill, Skill, Skill, Skill, Skill

AWARDS/RECOGNITIONS/VOLUNTEER WORK - (OPTIONAL)

- Award, recognition, or volunteer work Date
- Award, recognition, or volunteer work Date
- Award, recognition, or volunteer work Date

4. LINKEDIN PROFILE

A LinkedIn profile plays an important role in the modern job application process and in developing key interview skills, serving as a dynamic and interactive extension of your CV. Its impact extends to different aspects of the job search and professional networking, making it an essential tool for job seekers and professionals.

Role in Job Applications:

The role of LinkedIn in Job Applications are:

Professional Branding: Your LinkedIn profile functions as a platform for personal branding. It enables you to exhibit your professional identity, including your work experience, expertise, accomplishments, and professional passions, to potential employers and contacts.

Visibility to Recruiters: use LinkedIn to identify potential applicants for job vacancies. An efficiently optimised profile, with appropriate keywords and a thorough career summary, enhances your visibility in search results, hence increasing the likelihood of being identified for opportunities that align with your abilities and experiences.

Applying for Jobs: Job applications can be made directly through the LinkedIn site using its job search feature. Several job postings offer the option to apply using your LinkedIn profile, simplifying the application process and facilitating communication with possible employers.

Insights into Companies: LinkedIn offers excellent insights into companies through their official profiles, providing updates, new job openings, and information about the corporate culture. This can be important in customising your application and cover letter to certain companies.

Role in Interview Skills:

The role of LinkedIn in Job Applications are:

Research Tool: Before to an interview, you can utilise LinkedIn as a resource to gather information on th e company, its staff members, and particularly the individuals who will be conducting the interview. Gaining insight into their backgrounds and hobbies can facilitate the establishment of a connection during the interview and enable you to customise your responses to line with the company's beliefs and objectives.

Understanding Industry Trends: LinkedIn provides a wealth of articles, speaks, and professional perspectives on different industries, making it a valuable resource for understanding industry trends. Keeping informed of current developments and difficulties in your profession can enhance your knowledge as a candidate, enabling you to engage in fluent discussions about industry-specific topics during interviews.

Enhancing Skills: Utilising LinkedIn Learning and other professional development services on the network can enable you to acquire new skills or refine existing ones, thereby increasing your competitiveness as a candidate. Displaying a dedication to ongoing education can also serve as a favourable topic of discussion during interviews.

Networking: Networking on LinkedIn offers the advantage of gaining exclusive knowledge about the job application process and receiving interview advice customised to certain firms or industries. Networking can also result in references, greatly enhancing your likelihood of securing an interview and obtaining employment.

Post-Interview Etiquette: LinkedIn allows you to send thank-you notes to follow up after interviews, which helps maintain communication and shows your ongoing interest in the position.

4.1 Optimising for Visibility

An effective LinkedIn profile enhances your visibility to recruiters who are actively searching for candidates with your skills and experience. It allows you to present a comprehensive picture of your professional journey, including your education, work experience, skills, and any accolades you've received.

Your LinkedIn page is a digital resume and should accurately and effectively represent your professional image.

Tips to enhance the efficiency of your profile:

1. *Get a great professional profile picture:* A professional profile picture and a custom background can significantly impact first impressions. It sets a professional tone and makes your profile stand out.
2. *Have a customised background:* A customized background adds a personal touch, making your profile stand out and reflect your professional identity.
3. *Have a catchy, relevant, and optimised headline:* A well-crafted headline grabs attention and succinctly communicates your expertise and career goals.
4. *Have an authentic summary:* An authentic summary tells your professional story, highlighting your strengths and aspirations.
5. *Optimize your job title:* Customise your job title with relevant keywords to improve visibility and reflect your current role or career aspirations.
6. *Ensure that your work experience details section is optimised:* Detailed and keyword-optimized work experience descriptions showcase your achievements and skills.
7. *Optimize your skills section for better search ranking:* Carefully selected and optimised skills enhance your profile's searchability and attractiveness to recruiters.
8. *Write articles, share comments on people's articles, and like articles:* Writing and engaging with others' content demonstrates your industry involvement and expertise.
9. *Have strong endorsements and recommendations:* Strong endorsements and recommendations from peers validate your professional competencies and character.
10. *Utilize the feature section:* The feature section allows you to highlight significant accomplishments, projects, or publications.
11. *Edit and customise your LinkedIn URL:* A customised LinkedIn URL is easier to share and enhances your professional brand.

12. *Be active on LinkedIn and grow your network:* Regular activity on LinkedIn, including posting and networking, keeps your profile dynamic and expands your professional reach.
13. *Following Relevant Professionals:* Connecting with industry professionals, especially HR and recruiters, opens up opportunities and insights into the job market.

4.2 Networking Tips

The important 7 tips on how to Network on LinkedIn are:

i. Complete Your Profile
ii. Optimize Your Profile
iii. Get Endorsements
iv. Gather Connections from People You Know
v. Connect with Strangers in Your Field
vi. Join LinkedIn Groups
vii. Regularly Write Content

i. **Complete Your Profile:** Complete your profile, so that you just don't have much to say about yourself professionally.

So, make sure to add the following sections to your LinkedIn profile:

- A headline
- A profile photo and background picture
- A LinkedIn summary
- Current job title
- Your country and zip code
- Work experience with relevant dates.
- Education section
- Any volunteer work or other hobbies
- At least 5 relevant skills

ii. **Optimize your Profile:** Optimize your profile If you desire to distinguish yourself from the number of other applicants on the site.

So, implement below tips:

- Add a Professional-Looking, Friendly Profile Picture.
- Add an Effective Headline
- Create a Comprehensive and Eye-Catching Summary.
- Optimize Your Work Experience

iii. **Get Endorsements:** To gain endorsements on LinkedIn, proactively interact with your network by recommending the proficiencies of your connections, as many of them are likely to respond to the gesture. Additionally, it is advisable to professionally request endorsements from coworkers, previous classmates, or professionals with whom you have had close working relationships. It is important to emphasise certain areas of skills that you would like to highlight. Keep your talents section current and relevant to attract spontaneous testimonials from your network.

iv. **Gather Connections from People You Know:**

There are several methods to expand your LinkedIn network, but the initial and most dependable approach is establishing connections with individuals you are currently familiar with. Fortunately, there is a quite convenient method to locate them on LinkedIn. Begin by importing your entire phone contact list onto LinkedIn, then send them a connection request. Next, utilise the "People You May Know" functionality to discover other individuals you may not have previously encountered from your educational institution, workplace, or professional field.

To access this feature, simply touch the My Network option in the navigation bar. Then, scroll down until you reach the "People You May Know" area.

v. **Connect with Strangers in Your Field: The** objective of networking on LinkedIn is not to collect a large number of connections randomly. Instead, the goal is to establish significant relationships with individuals who might help in your career development.

- Do this by Sending invites to a manager, recruiter, or company representative who works in your specific field and can help you get your desired job position.
- Send a personalised message along with your request. For example, you can add 2-3 sentences explaining why you two should connect, such as: “Hello, I see that you work for Company X. I wanted to reach and connect because I am currently exploring new

job opportunities. I've been working for ABC Company for 4+ years, and I'm now ready for my next challenge".

vi. **Join LinkedIn Groups:** LinkedIn groups are specialised online platforms where professionals who share same interests or work in the same industry can exchange expertise, seek advice, and engage in discussions on issues of common interest. Participating in these groups can facilitate the establishment of new connections, promote the growth of collaborations, and showcase one's experience and knowledge.

LinkedIn simplifies discovering and joining these groups by allowing you to search for specific terms relevant to your industry, interests, or target customers.

vii. **Regularly Write Content:** Adapt your language to the LinkedIn audience by using a professional and powerful tone. Consistently make posts, typically at a frequency of multiple times per week. Enhance the post's appeal by including relevant visuals such as infographics and images.

5. INTERVIEW SKILLS

An interview is a process of interaction between one person and another person or persons. One party, who interviews has a specific purpose. The interview may be for a new job, promotion in a job, confirmation on a particular post, an admission, selection of a marriage partner, or any other purpose. Media people also, interview leaders, celebrities or somebody, who has some achievement or who has some message for the public. Depending on the purpose, the nature of interview may change. We may concentrate more on the job interviews. As the word "Interview" says, it is aimed at internal view or the internal and the external, means overall view of the person, to verify whether the person is suitable for the post or position or to verify the credentials, level or the achievement, he claims. It is not just hearing him or checking his written and oral communication skill but, also to assess his other attributes.

"Do"s and "Do not"s for the interview

Certain things are desirable for the interview: "DO" s

Preparedness:

Various forms of short term and long-term preparations are mentioned. The candidate should be well prepared for technical, nontechnical, and general knowledge aspects.

Know yourself:

Whatever details are covered in the application or CV or resume, the candidate should be familiar with it.

Documents:

In your application, you give many details about your academic qualification, achievements, experience, extra and co-curricular activities. All the original certificates or documents should be ready with you in the file. The documents should be arranged in the chronological sequence and list of all the documents in that sequence should be available with you. If possible, keep one set of Xeroxed copies, also.

Dress code: As mentioned earlier, you should be well dressed, suitable for the job and you should be comfortable in that dress.

Mental Stability: When you enter the interview room, you should be mentally stable. You should be relaxed.

Decent behavior outside: Sometimes, before the interview, when you are waiting outside, you may be watched directly or indirectly. Your behavior in the waiting lounge should be decent. You should be well behaved.

Reporting: For the interview you should report in time or slightly before time, so that you can settle.

Transportation: In transportation and local transit to interview place, keep proper margin to avoid delay. If possible, avoid driving vehicle by yourself to avoid tension leading to accident.

Blessings: Seek the blessings of the almighty, your parents and elders. Take good wishes of your friends, near ones and dear ones. It inspires confidence in you.

Entry: As soon as you enter the interview room, your interview starts. Enter the room by walking with confidence, at proper pace, not too fast, not too slow. Enter with a smiling face and establish eye contact with the interviewers.

Courtesy: Say "good morning Sirs" or "good afternoon sirs" as the case may be. Reach the chair specified for the candidate and request the permission to sit, by saying "may I sit, sirs?" When they say "yes" sit slowly, after saying "thank you, sir". Arrange your sit again, near the table. If your documents are in a small file folder you can keep it on the table but, if there is a big bag, keep it just near your chair.

Posture: While walking and entering the room, while sitting on the chair and while replying or reacting to the questions, proper posture is desirable, while sitting in the chair, you should be in attentive position. Your face should anticipate the questions. When a particular expert asks questions, you can turn your face towards him but, at the same time maintain eye contact or attention towards others.

Information about the Company: Advance information about the company is desirable and helpful.

Body Language: During the interview you have to prove your sincerity, frankness, confidence, talent, smartness, transparency, etc. Certain things are revealed by the question answer session but, many things are exposed and exhibited by your body language. Be careful about your body language, to give positive messages. Your communication and reactions should be polite, even if somebody is asking irritating questions. In an interview panel, only some people may be asking the questions but, others read your body language, to assess what you have claimed in the resume.

Communication: Effectiveness of communication will convince the interviewers about your capability and intentions. Listen the questions carefully and answer them to the point. Be brief in the answer, to avoid trapping your self.

Keenness for job: Your behavior during interview should reflect that you are interested in the job and have not just come for the experience of interview.

Answering techniques: Communication in an interview is for the selection purpose. Some questions require yes/no type answers. In some cases short answers are necessary. Some questions are asked for the sake of asking, just to check the response of the candidate to such questions or to irritate the candidate. It is better to keep mum in this case. Only when detailed information is asked about some topic, go in to the details, otherwise it may put you in difficulty.

Queries: Regarding the company, post, job function or pay structure, if you have some ambiguity, you can clarify with the HR department after the interview.

Art of diverting the interview to your interest: During the interview some times, you may get the chance to talk about your strength. Exploit the opportunity fully. You can talk about your qualities, achievements, experience, project, training, publications, research and many other things.

End of Interview: At the end of the interview, they should feel that you are happy with the interview process. With smiling face, you can say thank you and depart. If there are one or two persons in the panel, shaking the hands may be possible. But, if there is a large group of very senior people, shake hand may not be possible.

In an interview certain things, called "Do not"s should be avoided.

Late Reporting: It indicates lack of planning, lack of sincerity and puts you in tension.

- Avoid self driving a vehicle to the place of interview to avoid casualty under tension.
- Avoid last minute preparation and sleepless night.
- Unarranged or missing documents may put you in difficulty.
- Avoid reading your resume before the committee. You should know about your qualification, experience, achievements and convey it orally.
- Avoid uncomfortable dress. Also, avoid the dress which is not matching with the profession.
- Avoid unnecessary make up, perfume, etc. You have to impress the interviewers, not to seduce them.
- Avoid checking the tie, arranging the saree, rearranging hair, playing with hair and moustache.
- Avoid tension on your face and over seriousness.
- Do not sit without seeking permission.
- Sometimes, the candidate has to sit on a revolving chair. Do not revolve it unnecessarily.
- Do not stretch the feet too much, do not shake the feet and do not put one foot on the other.
- Avoid unnecessary movement of hand or fingers.
- Avoid bluffing. If you do not know any thing, confess it or keep mum.
- Avoid arrogance during interview process, even if provoked, do not lose your temper.
- Avoid mistakes in your communication. Do not start replying impatiently,without proper listening and then frequently saying sorry.
- If you do not follow the question, say "pardon me, sir." Do not say "what do you mean?" otherwise he will say "I mean you get out".
- During interaction process of the interview, avoid controversial statements and controversy with the panel members. In our system, boss is always considered right. Do not argue with him.
- Some people unnecessarily use a, an, the, with the proper nouns. Avoid it. It is poor communication.

- In communication, some people use some phrases repeatedly e.g. “I think”. “I mean”, “You know”, “It may be”, “Well”, “As such” which is not desirable.
- Avoid wrong pronunciation.
- Do not interrupt the interviewer in between. Let him complete first.
- Do not overpraise the new employer.
- Do not abuse the present employer.
- You can highlight your merit and achievements but, do not boast about yourself.
- Do not criticize others.
- You may be a competent person but, do not over estimate yourself and underestimate others.
- Do not show that you are interested only in money and not ready to take up new challenges and responsibilities.
- Do not talk about rivals of the company or rivals of interviewers.
- Use English for communication. Do not mix other languages.
- If you have the changed jobs at very small intervals, do not mention those which were of very small duration or the experience is not relevant to the present job. Frequently changing a job is a negative point. If you blame the company for it, the other side will not believe it.

5.1 STAR Technique

The STAR method is a structured manner of responding to a behavioral-based interview question by discussing the specific situation, task, action, and result of the situation you are describing.

Situation: Describe the situation that you were in or the task that you needed to accomplish. You must describe a specific event or situation, not a generalized description of what you have done in the past. Be sure to give enough detail for the interviewer to understand. This situation can be from a previous job, from a volunteer experience, or any relevant event.

Task: What goal were you working toward?

Action: Describe the actions you took to address the situation with an appropriate amount of detail and keep the focus on YOU. What specific steps did you take and what was your

particular contribution? Be careful that you don't describe what the team or group did when talking about a project, but what you actually did. Use the word "I," not "we" when describing actions.

Result: Describe the outcome of your actions and don't be shy about taking credit for your behavior. What happened? How did the event end? What did you accomplish? What did you learn? Make sure your answer contains multiple positive results.

SAMPLE STAR RESPONSE:

Situation (S): Advertising revenue was falling off for my college newspaper, The Review, and large numbers of long-term advertisers were not renewing contracts.

Task (T): My goal was to generate new ideas, materials and incentives that would result in at least a 15% increase in advertisers from the year before.

Action (A): I designed a new promotional packet to go with the rate sheet and compared the benefits of The Review circulation with other ad media in the area. I also set-up a special training session for the account executives with a School of Business Administration professor who discussed competitive selling strategies.

Result (R): We signed contracts with 15 former advertisers for daily ads and five for special supplements. We increased our new advertisers by 20 percent over the same period last year.

5.2 Behavioural Questions

Behavioural questions are queries asked during an interview that show your ability to handle work situations, challenges, or circumstances. These evaluations attempt to provide an understanding of your capabilities, competencies, and personal qualities and can assist interviewers in predicting your future behaviour. Referred to as situational interview questions, these inquiries request particular work experience accompanied by extensive explanations of the circumstances, action taken, and consequence achieved. They explore more than just outlining the duties and responsibilities of previous positions.

HOW TO PREPARE FOR A BEHAVIORAL INTERVIEW

- Recall recent situations that show favourable behaviours or actions, especially involving coursework, work experience, leadership, teamwork, initiative, planning, and customer service.
- Prepare short descriptions of each situation; be ready to give details if asked.
- Be sure each story has a beginning, middle, and an end, i.e., be ready to describe the situation, including the task at hand, your action, and the outcome or result.
- Be sure the outcome or result reflects positively on you (even if the result itself was not favourable).
- Be honest. Don't embellish or omit any part of the story. The interviewer will find out if your story is built on a weak foundation.
- Be specific. Don't generalize about several events; give a detailed accounting of one event.
- Vary your examples; don’t take them all from just one area of your life.

SAMPLE BEHAVIORAL INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- Practice using the STAR Method on these common behavioral interviewing questions:
- Describe a situation in which you were able to use persuasion to successfully convince someone to see things your way.
- Describe a time when you were faced with a stressful situation that demonstrated your coping skills.
- Give me a specific example of a time when you used good judgment and logic in solving a problem.
- Give me an example of a time when you set a goal and were able to meet or achieve it.
- Tell me about a time when you had to use your presentation skills to influence someone's opinion.
- Give me a specific example of a time when you had to conform to a policy with which you did not agree.
- Please discuss an important written document you were required to complete.
- Tell me about a time when you had to go above and beyond the call of duty in order to get a job done.

- Tell me about a time when you had too many things to do and you were required to prioritize your tasks.
- Give me an example of a time when you had to make a split second decision.
- What is your typical way of dealing with conflict? Give me an example.
- Tell me about a time you were able to successfully deal with another person even when that individual may not have personally liked you (or vice versa).
- Tell me about a difficult decision you've made in the last year.
- Give me an example of a time when something you tried to accomplish and failed.
- Give me an example of when you showed initiative and took the lead.
- Tell me about a recent situation in which you had to deal with a very upset customer or coworker.
- Give me an example of a time when you motivated others.
- Tell me about a time when you delegated a project effectively.
- Give me an example of a time when you used your fact-finding skills to solve a problem.
- Tell me about a time when you missed an obvious solution to a problem.
- Describe a time when you anticipated potential problems and developed preventive measures.
- Tell me about a time when you were forced to make an unpopular decision.
- Please tell me about a time you had to fire a friend.
- Describe a time when you set your sights too high (or too low).

5.3 Post-Interview Etiquette

- Send a thank you note within 24 hours of the interview. Check out a sample thank you note for inspiration.
- Evaluate your performance. Did any questions stump you? Consider how you can improve your answers for the next interview.
- Think about what you learned about the position and employer during the interview. Assess how the position would meet your priorities and goals.
- After a first round interview you may be called back for additional rounds of interviews depending on the employer's process. Check out our resource on what to expect at a second round interview to help you prepare.

- If a job offer is provided on the spot, which is uncommon, it is appropriate to thank the employer and to tell them that you need more time to consider the offer. Ask about the company's timeline and deadline for your answer.
- If you do not hear from the employer after the hiring timeline they initially indicated, follow up once. Call or email the interviewer or human resources contact. Reaffirm your interest in the position and inquire about the new hiring timeline.

6. SUMMARY

This unit offers a great guide for individuals seeking employment, beginning with the creation of effective cover letters that emphasise the importance of customising the content to align with specific job positions. Implementing this personalisation strategy is essential for creating a powerful first impression on hiring managers. Learners also studied resume writing, which provided valuable insights into different forms and emphasised the significance of showcasing personal accomplishments. Creating ATS-friendly resumes is emphasised to successfully navigate automated screening processes and ensure that human recruiters review a candidate's CV.

In this unit, learners have studied the techniques for improving LinkedIn profiles to increase visibility among recruiters and offer strategic networking advice to best utilise the platform's advantages. The extensive coverage encompasses interview preparation, including introducing the STAR technique as a strategy for effectively answering behavioural questions by providing specific examples demonstrating problem-solving abilities. The discussion also covers post-interview etiquette, emphasising the significance of follow-up communications. It provides guidance to candidates on how to create a memorable and favourable impression on potential employers. This approach equips learners with a comprehensive comprehension of the job application process, encompassing the creation of influential applications and proficiency in the interview stage.

7. SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS – 1

1. What is the primary purpose of a cover letter according to the content?
   a) To introduce your résumé in a graceful way.
   b) To replace the résumé with a more modern approach.
   c) To question the necessity of traditional job application methods.
   d) To provide a list of references.
2. What are the three primary parts of a cover letter?
   a) Introduction, hobbies, and conclusion.
   b) Opening, body, and closing.
   c) Salutation, experience, and signature.
   d) Skills, achievements, and certifications.
3. How should a cover letter be customised according to the content?
   a) By using a standard template for all job applications.
   b) Tailoring it to the department and specific requirements of the position.
   c) Including as many personal anecdotes as possible.
   d) Focusing solely on past job titles and responsibilities.
4. Which resume format is described as optimal for individuals with a constant and progressive employment path?
   a) Chronological
   b) Functional
   c) Combination
   d) Creative
5. What is a primary focus of a functional resume?
   a) Presenting work history in a sequential order
   b) Focusing on key abilities over employment history
   c) Highlighting a mix of skills and work experience
   d) Showcasing creative talents and design skills

6. What should NOT be done when formatting a resume to be ATS-friendly according to the guide?
   a) Use a professional, readable font
   b) Apply appropriate margins
   c) Include detailed descriptions using complex fonts
   d) Make your font size 10–12 points
7. What is the primary role of a LinkedIn profile in the job application process?
   a) To replace the traditional CV entirely.
   b) To serve as a dynamic and interactive extension of your CV.
   c) To function only as a social network.
   d) To communicate with friends and family about job searches.
8. What is a key strategy for enhancing your LinkedIn profile's visibility to recruiters?
   a) Ignoring the skills section as it is deemed irrelevant by most recruiters.
   b) Keeping a minimalistic profile with very little information.
   c) Optimising your profile with relevant keywords and a thorough career summary.
   d) Sharing only personal achievements unrelated to the job.
9. What is the primary purpose of an interview according to the content provided?
   a) To assess the candidate's ability to drive.
   b) To verify whether the person is suitable for the post or to verify credentials.
   c) To test the candidate's knowledge of current events.
   d) To evaluate the candidate's social media profiles.

10. Which resume format focuses on key abilities rather than employment history?
    a) Chronological
    b) Functional
    c) Combination
    d) Reverse chronological
11. According to the content, what technique is recommended for responding to behavioral-based interview questions?
    a) The STAR method
    b) The ABC method
    c) The 5 Ws method
    d) The direct method
12. What should a candidate do if they do not hear back from the employer within the initially indicated hiring timeline?
    a) Immediately accept another job offer.
    b) Post about the delay on social media.
    c) Follow up once by calling or emailing the interviewer or HR contact.
    d) Assume rejection and stop pursuing the position.

INSPIRED BY LIFE

8. TERMINAL QUESTIONS

1. Elucidate the structure of Cover Letter with an example.
2. Explicate the popular resume formats.
3. Briefly explain the ATS Resume template.
4. Explain the tips to optimize LinkedIn Visibility.
5. Write a short note on STAR technique.

9. ANSWERS

Self-Assessment Answers

1. Introduce your résumé in a graceful way.
2. Opening, body, and closing.
3. Tailoring it to the department and specific requirements of the position.
4. Chronological
5. Focusing on key abilities over employment history
6. Include detailed descriptions using complex fonts
7. To serve as a dynamic and interactive extension of your CV.
8. Optimising your profile with relevant keywords and a thorough career summary.
9. To verify whether the person is suitable for the post or to verify credentials.
10. Functional
11. STAR Method
12. Follow up once by calling or emailing the interviewer or HR contact.

Terminal Answers

1. Refer to the section 1.1.
2. Refer to the section 2
3. Refer to the section 2.3
4. Refer to the section 3.1
5. Refer to the section 4.1

10. REFERENCES

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Website Links:

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4. How To Write an ATS Resume (With Template and Tips) | Indeed.com
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7. How to Network on LinkedIn - 7 Proven Tips for 2024 (novoresume.com)
8. The STAR Method of Behavioral Interviewing (vawizard.org)
9. 25 Behavioural Interview Questions (With Example Answers) | Indeed.com India
10. The STAR Method of Behavioral Interviewing (vawizard.org)
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